

**Board 1**

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A K 7 5 4 3

♥ J 9 5

♦ —

♣ J 10 7 2

♠ —

♥ K 8 4

♦ A K J 7 6 5 2

♣ A 6 5

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ 10 9 6

♥ Q 10 7 2

♦ 9 4 3

♣ K Q 8

♠ Q J 8 2

♥ A 6 3

♦ Q 10 8

♣ 9 4 3

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
| 2 ♠          | Dbl   | Pass | 2NT   |
| Pass         | 3 ♦   | Pass | 4 ♦   |
| Pass         | 5 ♦   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 5 ♦ by North |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♠ 10   |       |      |       |

3NT would have been a lot easier, but you didn't get there. North is to play 5 ♦. East leads the ♠ 10.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=0 ♣=2 Total = 3

The good news is that you only have one loser to get rid of. The bad news is that there doesn't seem to be a good place to put it.

Unlikely as it seems, your best candidate for establishment is dummy's ♠ 8. East is marked with 3 ♠s, and having led the ♠ 10 there is a good chance that he also has the ♠ 9. If so you can ruff it out.

Cover the ♠ 10 with dummy's ♠ J, and when West plays one of his honors ruff in your hand. Play a trump to the ♦ 10, West showing out. Lead the ♠ Q. West will be forced to play his other high honor, (if he doesn't you would discard a loser), and you ruff again.

Back to dummy with the ♦ Q and ruff the ♠ 2 with a high trump just to be safe. East drops the ♠ 9 on this trick.

Pull East's last trump and enter dummy with the ♥ A and **FINALLY** discard a loser on the now established ♠ 8.

When your only hope of making a contract is for the defender's cards to be a certain way, just assume that they lie perfectly for you and barge ahead.

Here you needed ♠ 10 9 x to be with East if you were to make the contract so you played for just that holding.

**Board 2**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 3  
♥ J 7 6 4  
♦ K J 7 3 2  
♣ 10 5

♠ K 6 4

♥ A 9 3

♦ 8 6

♣ 9 8 6 4 3

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ 8 2

♥ Q 8 2

♦ Q 10 9 4

♣ Q J 7 2

♠ A Q J 10 9 7

♥ K 10 5

♦ A 5

♣ A K

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             | Pass  | Pass | 2♣    |
| Pass        | 2NT   | Pass | 3♠    |
| Pass        | 4♠    | Pass | 4NT   |
| Pass        | 5♦    | Pass | 6♠    |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 6♠ by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♠5    |       |      |       |

South is to play 6♠. West leads the ♠5.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=1 ♣=0 Total = 2

First pull trumps with the ♠A and ♠Q, both defenders following. Next you must establish dummy's ♣ suit to get rid of one of your losers. If the suit splits 3-3 that will be easy since you have two dummy entries, one to get there to ruff the third ♣ and the other to get there to enjoy playing the winners. But ♣s will probably split 4-2 so the two entries won't be enough. Here's how to make the defenders help you establish the suit.

After pulling trumps, play the ♣ A K, then ♦ A. Next exit with a small ♦.

The defender who won the ♦ trick has a problem. If he plays another ♦ you will get a ruff-sluff, and if he plays a ♥ you will play for the ♥Q and ♥J to be in different hands. So he will probably play a ♣.

You ruff in your hand, play a trump to dummy's ♠K and ruff the ♣8, establishing the ♣9 while you still have the ♥ entry.

Notice that this Plan would also succeed if the ♣s had split 3-3.

This was a combination of Suit Establishment and End-play. The lesson on Eliminations contains a lot more of this type of hand.